

David Kowalski

Game Developer | Unity & Unreal Engine Specialist

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🎮 itch.io/dkowalski

Passionate game developer with 5+ years of professional experience creating engaging gameplay systems and polished player experiences across multiple platforms. Specialized in Unity and Unreal Engine with strong expertise in C#, C++, and game design principles. Proven ability to collaborate effectively with cross-functional teams including designers, artists, and QA to deliver high-quality games on time and within scope.

University of Washington Bachelor of Science • 3.6 GPA
Computer Science Seattle, WA • 2014 - 2018
Concentration in Game Development. Relevant Coursework: Game Engine Architecture, Computer Graphics, Artificial Intelligence, Physics Simulation, 3D Mathematics, Software Engineering, Data Structures & Algorithms

Cascade Studios Seattle, WA
Senior Game Developer March 2022 - Present

- Lead gameplay programmer on an unannounced AAA action-adventure title built in Unreal Engine 5 for PC and next-gen consoles
- Architected and implemented core combat system including hit detection, combo mechanics, and enemy AI behavior trees serving 15+ enemy types
- Developed custom editor tools in C++ that reduced level designer iteration time by 40% and improved workflow efficiency across the team
- Optimized rendering pipeline and gameplay systems to maintain 60 FPS performance target on all supported platforms, achieving 95% frame rate stability
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🐙 **GitHub**
[dkowalski-dev](https://github.com/dkowalski-dev)

🌐 **LinkedIn**
[davidkowalski](https://www.linkedin.com/in/davidkowalski)

</> **Unity Engine**
Expert
C#, Editor Tools, Performance Profiling
☆☆☆☆☆

{ } **Unreal Engine**
Advanced
C++, Blueprints, UE5 Features
☆☆☆☆☆

🔧 **Programming Languages**
Expert
C#, C++, Python, HLSL/GLSL
☆☆☆☆☆

🧠 **Game AI**
Advanced
Behavior Trees, FSM, Pathfinding, Navigation
☆☆☆☆☆

🌟 **Physics & Mathematics**

Advanced

3D Math, Collision Detection, Rigid Body Dynamics



Pixel Forge Interactive

Game Developer

- Core developer on 'Starbound Odyssey,' a sci-fi roguelike that achieved 500K+ sales on Steam with 'Very Positive' user reviews
- Implemented procedural generation systems for level layouts, enemy encounters, and loot drops using Unity and C#
- Designed and programmed player progression systems including skill trees, equipment upgrades, and meta-progression mechanics
- Created robust save/load system supporting cloud saves and cross-platform play between PC and Nintendo Switch
- Integrated third-party SDKs for analytics (GameAnalytics), achievements (Steamworks), and multiplayer networking (Photon)
- Fixed critical bugs and balanced gameplay based on community feedback and telemetry data, releasing 12 post-launch content updates
- Worked closely with artists to implement VFX, animations, and shaders that enhanced visual polish while maintaining performance targets

Bellevue, WA

June 2020 - February 2022

Mobile Games Studio

Junior Game Developer

- Contributed to development of three mobile puzzle games built in Unity, collectively downloaded 2M+ times on iOS and Android
- Implemented UI systems, touch controls, and gesture recognition optimized for mobile devices and various screen sizes
- Developed monetization features including rewarded video ads, in-app purchases, and daily reward systems that increased retention by 25%
- Optimized memory usage and load times for mobile platforms, reducing app size by 35% through asset compression and code optimization
- Collaborated with game designers to balance puzzle difficulty curves and progression pacing using A/B testing data

Remote

September 2018 - May 2020

Best Gameplay - Ludum Dare 48

Ludum Dare

Awarded for puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' which ranked in the top 5% overall among 3,000+ submissions

April 2021

Employee Excellence Award

Pixel Forge Interactive

Recognized for exceptional contributions to 'Starbound Odyssey' development and dedication to code quality

December 2021

Unity Certified Expert: Programmer

Unity Technologies

March 2022

Unreal Engine 5 C++ Developer

Epic Games (Udemy)

June 2023

English

Native

☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Polish

Conversational

☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Game Design

Mechanics, Level Design, Player Psychology

AI & Procedural Generation

PCG, Machine Learning, Emergent Gameplay

Indie Game Development

Solo Dev, Game Jams, Community



Technical Art

Shaders, VFX, Optimization

Available upon request

Echoes of the Void (Indie Game)		2023 - Present
Solo developer for a narrative-driven 2D platformer built in Unity. Features custom dialogue system, branching story paths, and atmospheric pixel art. Currently in development with demo released on itch.io garnering 5K+ downloads and positive community feedback. Planned Steam release Q2 2025.		
View on itch.io		
Open Source: Unity Dialogue Framework		2021 - 2023
Created and maintain an open-source dialogue system for Unity with visual node-based editor, localization support, and voice acting integration. Project has 800+ GitHub stars and is actively used by indie developers worldwide. Includes comprehensive documentation and example projects.		
View on GitHub		
Game Jam Participation		2019 - Present
Regular participant in Ludum Dare and Global Game Jam events. Created 12+ game prototypes exploring experimental mechanics and art styles. Won 'Best Gameplay' award at Ludum Dare 48 with puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' that ranked in top 5% overall.		
Optimizing Unity Games for Mobile: A Practical Guide		September 2021
Game Developer Magazine		
Technical article covering mobile optimization techniques including draw call batching, LOD systems, and memory management		
Building Modular Dialogue Systems		May 2022
Seattle Indie Game Developers Meetup		
Presented talk on designing flexible dialogue systems for narrative games, attended by 60+ local developers		
Seattle Indies	2020 - Present	Code.org Game Development Workshops 2021 - Present
Seattle, WA		Seattle, WA
Active member of local indie game development community.		Volunteer instructor teaching basic game programming concepts
Organize monthly game showcases and provide mentorship to aspiring game developers through code reviews and technical guidance.		to middle school students. Led 8+ workshops introducing Unity fundamentals and game design principles.

Hiring Manager
Sunrise Games Studio
Seattle, WA
hire@sunrisegames.com

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm excited to apply for the Senior Gameplay Engineer role at Sunrise Games Studio. Over the past five years, I have shipped cross-platform titles in Unity and Unreal Engine, leading core gameplay and tooling efforts that improved iteration speed and player experience. At Cascade Studios, I architected combat systems and optimized performance to maintain 60 FPS on console while partnering closely with design and art.

I thrive in collaborative, cross-disciplinary teams and enjoy mentoring junior engineers. I'd welcome the chance to bring my gameplay systems expertise and tooling focus to your next title.

Sincerely,
David Kowalski